

3. Barstow Open House: [Link to Blog](#)

Eighty-four people had filled our Barstow office to celebrate its newly renovated waiting room.

The mayor came.

It felt like the whole town turned out.

Then, around three o'clock, after everyone had already gone home - a woman walked in.

She was holding her phone, with our digital invitation open on her screen.

Back in 2019, she'd placed her baby daughter for adoption, and she'd never spoken about it.

Not once in six years.

So we sat with her, warmed up a plate of tacos, and listened.

She'd carried so much shame, but she'd never stopped thinking about her daughter.

So I told her that I was adopted as a baby, along with my twin sister.

I just wanted her to see that the child she placed could grow up, and be okay.

Because she'd never had the opportunity to see the other side.

And sitting right across the table from her was a person who was that baby at one point in time -

grown,

whole,

living proof of what the woman's daughter could become.

And when she realized all of this - something in her softened.

And she left lighter than she'd come.

So if you're carrying something alone, our door is open.

A Greater Hope, in Barstow.

Editor's Note:

END CARD (on-screen text)

833-947-1347

care@aghope.org

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